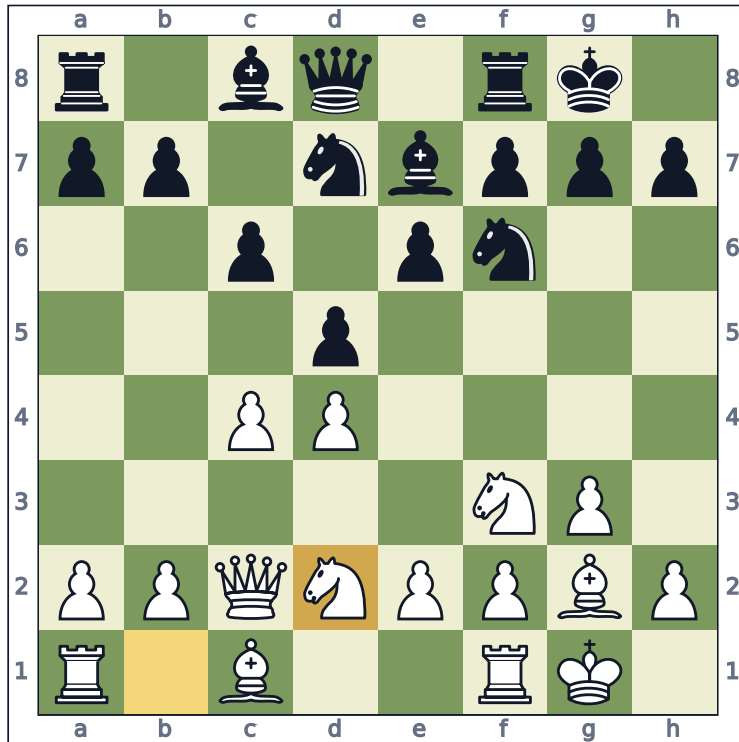


CATALAN OPENING

Catalan Opening

ECO E09 | 6 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.55 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Strategic and flexible: small move-order choices decide which pawn structure appears.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

E09 covers Catalan Opening. White combines d4 and c4 with a g2 bishop, seeking long-term pressure and excellent piece activity. The diagram uses the featured line Catalan Opening: Closed, Main Line.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Qc2 c6 8. Nbd2

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the long diagonal, recover a sacrificed c-pawn without losing coordination, and press queenside weaknesses patiently.

BLACK'S GOALS

Choose whether to hold c4, return it for development, or close the diagonal; seek ...c5 or ...e5 for freedom.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 challenge the center; White often uses Ne5, Qc2, and a4 to recover or undermine c4.

PIECE MAP

The g2 bishop is the soul of White's position. Black must manage the a8-h1 diagonal and queenside development. White's g2 bishop makes the long diagonal a strategic asset.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

White should not rush to regain a pawn if doing so loses the initiative; Black should not cling to it at any cost. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, Black pawn on c6, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A top-class strategic opening, especially strong for players who enjoy durable pressure rather than forced attacks.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named E09 line

This section preserves all 6 names and defining routes assigned to E09 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Catalan Opening: Closed Variation, Rabinovich Variation
1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Qc2 e6 5. Nbd2 Be7 6. g3 Nbd7 7. Bg2 O-O 8. O-O b5

002 Catalan Opening: Closed Variation, Traditional Variation
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Qc2 c6 8. Nbd2 b6

003 Catalan Opening: Closed, Main Line
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Qc2 c6 8. Nbd2

004 Catalan Opening: Closed, Main Line
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O c6 7. Qc2 b6 8. Nbd2 Bb7 9. e4 Nbd7

005 Catalan Opening: Closed, Main Line
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Qc2 c6 8. Bf4 b6 9. Nbd2 Bb7 10. e4 dxe4 11. Nxe4 Nxe4 12. Qxe4

006 Catalan Opening: Closed, Sokolsky Variation
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. g3 d5 4. Bg2 Be7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Qc2 c6 8. Nbd2 b6 9. b3 a5 10. Bb2 Ba6